

JSON format by default. The command optionally takes a list of apps whose data you are interested in. As the data is in JSON, the `json.tool` module built into Python can be handy; running it directly through `python -m pretty` prints the output. The following line dumps the band app to the screen in JSON, in a human readable format:

```
(venv) RiffMates$ python manage.py dumpdata bands | python -m json.tool
```

The output is a JSON representation of all the musicians, bands, venues, and rooms you created in the database. The content is serialized as a JSON list. The following shows two portions of the output, the serialized Steve Vai Musician object and the serialized Wishful Thinking Band:

```
[
  {
    "model": "bands.musician",
    "pk": 1,
    "fields": {
      "first_name": "Steve",
      "last_name": "Vai",
      "birth": "1960-06-06"
    }
  },
  ...
  {
    "model": "bands.band",
    "pk": 2,
    "fields": {
      "name": "Wishful Thinking",
      "musicians": [1, 2, 3 ]
    }
  },
  ...
]
```

**The fixture content is a JSON list.**

**A string indicates the app and name of the model for this object.**

**The pk is the primary key, in this case the unique ID.**

**The fields dictionary serializes the fields for the object.**

**A many-to-many relationship is represented as a list of keys.**

The companion to `dumpdata` is intuitively named `loaddata`. You specify what data to load via a filename or an app name. Dump the data again, this time without the pretty printing, and redirect the content into a file named `bands.json`:

```
(venv) RiffMates$ python manage.py dumpdata bands > bands.json
```

### When your IDE is not your friend

You have to be careful not to accidentally corrupt a fixture output by `dumpdata`, as you might make it impossible to load back in again later. Although a fixture is just a text file, there are text files, and then there are *text files*. Different operating systems use different characters to indicate a newline. Some editors will insert a *byte-order mark* (BOM) ([https://www.unicode.org/faq/utf\\_bom.html#bom1](https://www.unicode.org/faq/utf_bom.html#bom1)) when encountering Unicode content.